Water: Fix the Leaks Before the Brochures

Executive Summary

Fixing the northern mains leak cluster is the highest-return water project on the shortlist.

Analysis

Detectors logged 1.9 megalitres of monthly loss across eleven hydrants; repairing them costs about 740 thousand dollars and pays back in under three years at the current bulk price.

Greywater recycling for the two aquatic centres looks attractive on brochures but the retrofit plumbing quotes came back at triple the feasibility study's estimate, so we parked it.

Smart metering the commercial basin, about 4,100 accounts, is the sleeper: the trial found 6 percent of accounts with faulty old meters that under-billed, which is pure recovered revenue.

Recommendation

Rainwater harvesting mandates for new builds don't move the needle much at city scale; the yield estimates are modest and enforcement would land on a building department that is already two years behind on inspections.

We recommend the leak repairs and the commercial metering roll-out, sequenced so the recovered revenue part-funds the second stage.

Case Prompt (identical for all candidates - do not modify): You are a strategy consultant engaged by the City Development Authority. Rising demand on public services and tightening municipal budgets have created pressure to identify fundable, high-impact interventions. Your task is to evaluate the feasibility of two shortlisted infrastructure initiatives, quantify expected costs and benefits over a five-year horizon, and recommend a phased implementation plan. Your submission must address financing options, stakeholder resistance, and delivery risks, and must include an executive summary, a structured analysis, and a clearly justified final recommendation supported by evidence. Word limit: 600 words. Citations are permitted where they support the analysis. Late submissions are scored as incomplete, and all claims must be

verifiable from the provided case pack data.